

Serving God Through Serving Our Community

For I am not ashamed of the gospel, because it is the power of God that brings salvation to everyone who believes: first to the Jew, then to the Gentile.

Romans 1:16

This year at Outreach Ministry, we seek to surrender fully to God's will, letting Him use us as vessels to reach those around us. Our desire is to be a place where His love flows through us to touch lives, remembering that it is His power, not our own, that transforms hearts and draws people to Him.

Ultimately, it is God who changes hearts, and it is God who brings us to Him. Our role as Christians in outreach is to act as vessels to allow His work to be done through us. While participating in outreach, it is our prayer that our focus remain solely on God, and what God can do, and not shift to what we as humans can do. While we may plant seeds or walk alongside newcomers to the faith, it is God who works – not us.

Being a testament to God is a core part of our identity as followers of Christ. We have been called to go and make disciples of all nations by God, who grieves for those who are lost, and desires for them to know him and come to repentance. As his children are saved by his love, we have adopted this same hope and continue to work out of an overflow of God's love for those who are suffering and struggling with their own life challenges, seeking answers. Oftentimes, we become so absorbed in our lives and desires that we forget this. Yet God's abundant love extends far beyond our own limited perspective, reaching every person with the same grace and compassion He has shown us. A significant part of outreach this year is to cultivate this heart posture within ourselves, and to be so deeply rooted in God's love that our motivations are purified. When we engage in outreach, it will not stem from a place of obligation or pridefulness but because we have been transformed by His pure love and cannot help but share it with others. Only when we are filled with God's selfless love can we genuinely and purely love those around us, becoming authentic vessels of His heart for the lost and hurting.

Therefore, go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, and teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you. And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age.

Matthew 28:19-20

Instead, the Lord is patient with you, not wanting anyone to perish, but everyone to come to repentance.

2 Peter 3:9

Oftentimes, we get so focused on the work aspect of outreach that we begin to depend on our own strength. We begin to focus too much on how well we speak, how impressive our outreach events are, and this robs God of his glory and limits his work in our lives. However, at the core of outreach is surrender and humility, realizing that you are no more important than the person you are reaching out to, and that apart from Christ, you can do nothing. Even when we have cultivated the right heart posture of love, we must also maintain a heart posture of complete surrender, not relying on our carefully planned programs, our polished presentations, or our need for things to unfold according to our expectations. True surrender

means trusting God even when our plans fall apart, when words fail us, or when circumstances seem to work against us. It is in these moments of apparent failure that God often does His greatest work. When we empty ourselves of our own abilities and agendas, acknowledging our complete dependence on Him, we create space for the Holy Spirit to move powerfully through us. And so this year, we also desire to walk and encourage one another to have hearts of surrender, so that his power can work with us to transform lives and bring others to him.

I planted the seed, Apollos watered it, but God has been making it grow. So neither the one who plants nor the one who waters is anything but only God, who makes things grow. The one who plants and the one who waters have one purpose, and they will each be rewarded according to their own labor. For we are co-workers in God's service; you are God's field, God's building.

1 Corinthians 3:6-9

Practical ways we will outreach this year:

1. Serving our community
 - a. Creating Care Packages and Delivering Them
 - b. Bread and Bible Verses
 - c. Volunteering at Soup Kitchens
2. Increasing the opportunity to bring non-Christian friends to learn about the Gospel
 - a. Increased Activity Nights
 - i. E.g. Baking Bible Study Themed snacks as a group before Bible Study
 - b. Potential Alpha Sessions (<https://alphacanada.org/>)
3. On-Campus Evangelism
 - a. Partnering with P2C and other fellowships to have outreach events!
 - i. E.g. Ask a Question, Get a Donut
 - ii. E.g. Blessings - where we ask people on the street how we can bless them
 - b. Relevant Series!
4. Being prepared to share the Gospel
 - a. Practicing sharing the Gospel to one another
 - b. Practicing sharing our testimonies